Scale Exercises - Section IV, Level 38

Major pentatonic call-and-response phrasing and improvisation synthesis

FIXED KEY: A | FIVE POSITIONS | CHORDS: A - D - E

Stop sounding like a scale exercise. State a short idea, leave measured space, answer the active chord, and develop the motif while the five-position map remains connected.

1. State a recognizable call

Use a compact rhythm and contour. A question may finish on degree 2 or 6 instead of pretending every phrase is final.

2. Answer the active harmony

Echo or contrast the call, but land on A/C#/E over A, F#/A over D, and E/B over E.

3. Develop, move, and leave space

Change one parameter at a time: target, contour, position, density, or articulation. Count the rests.

Worked overview - one seed, one harmonic answer

The rhythm remains recognizable; the D response changes the landing target.

```
A CALL - seed question                          D RESPONSE - harmonic answer
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    C#   B    r    r    r    |  Nte |F#   A    r    B    A    r    r    r    |
Deg |1    2    r    3    2    r    r    r    |  Deg |6    1    r    2    1    r    r    r    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    P    r    r    r    |  Atk |P    P    r    P    P    r    r    r    |
e   |                                         |  e   |                                         |
B   |                                         |  B   |                                         |
G   |              6                          |  G   |                                         |
D   |7    h9             9                    |  D   |     7         9    7~                   |
A   |                                         |  A   |9                                        |
E   |                                         |  E   |                                         |
```

Call: A-B-C#-B. Response: F#-A-B-A. Same family; different harmonic arrival.

Session protocol

1. Clap the call rhythm.
2. Play five local pairs.
3. Connect four seams.
4. Transform one seed.
5. Control phrase density.
6. Learn the 12-bar chorus.
7. Record three choruses.

Core-workout count and boundary

312 written sounding tones and 237 pick attacks: 55 local-pair tones, 97 seam-phrase tones, 30 transformation tones, 60 density-ladder tones, and a 70-tone model chorus. D* and G#* remain temporary chord-completion tones, not additions to the A-major-pentatonic formula.

Level 38 - Phrase Grammar, Target Map, and Attack Legend

A response stays related to the call while changing its harmonic job.

Phrase function	Typical ending	Response goal	Common failure
Question / call	Degree 2 or 6; or a strong tone followed by silence	Preserve rhythm or contour; change target or register	Filling every eighth-note slot
Echo response	Same rhythm; related contour	Land on the new chord target	Copying the same frets over every chord
Contrast response	Opposite contour or shorter density	Resolve the tension created by the call	Changing rhythm, contour, position, and articulation at once
Cadential answer	A, C#, or E over tonic A	Sound complete without rushing the last note	Searching for the root after the phrase already ended

Chord	Strong pentatonic arrivals	Useful motion colors	Completion tone
A major	A root | C# third | E fifth	B ninth | F# thirteenth	None
D major	F# third | A fifth	B thirteenth | E ninth | C# major-7 tension	D* root
E major	E root | B fifth	F# ninth | C# thirteenth | A sus4 tension	G#* third

Motif identity

Keep at least two of these recognizable: rhythm, contour, interval direction, articulation pattern, or ending gesture. Exact frets are not required.

Measured silence

A rest has a beginning and an end. Count it with the same precision as a note. Silence before the answer makes the response easier to hear.

One change at a time

Change target first. Then experiment with position, contour, density, or articulation. Too many simultaneous changes erase the motif.

Symbol	Meaning	Picking rule
P	Picked attack	Alternate through actual attacks; start once with D and once with U.
h / p	Hammer-on / pull-off destination	Do not add a pick to the destination.
s / b	Slide / bend destination	Arrival remains on the written subdivision.
r / =	Rest / held tone	A rest is silent; a hold continues the previous pitch.

Level 38 - Local Question-and-Answer Pairs (P1 / P2)

One position, two related sentences, and a deliberate phrase boundary.

P1 - ROOT FRAME - FRETS 4-7

Call ends F# (degree 6); answer ends A (root).

```
CALL                                                RESPONSE
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    C#   E    F#   r    r    |   Nte |C#   E    r    F#   E    C#   A    =    |
Deg |1    2    r    3    5    6    r    r    |   Deg |3    5    r    6    5    3    1    =    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    h    P    r    r    |   Atk |P    h    r    P    P    p    P    =    |
e   |                                        |   e   |                                        |
B   |                                        |   B   |                                        |
G   |                                        |   G   |                                        |
D   |                   4                    |   D   |                   4                    |
A   |              4    h7                   |   A   |4    h7             7    p4              |
E   |5    h7                                 |   E   |                             5~         |
```

Practice: call -> one bar of silence -> response; then remove the extra bar without losing the boundary.

P2 - SECOND-DEGREE FRAME - FRETS 6-10

Call ends B (degree 2); answer ends A (root).

```
CALL                                                RESPONSE
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |C#   E    r    F#   A    B    r    r    |   Nte |E    F#   r    A    C#   E    A    =    |
Deg |3    5    r    6    1    2    r    r    |   Deg |5    6    r    1    3    5    1    =    |
Atk |P    P    r    P    P    h    r    r    |   Atk |P    h    r    P    P    h    P    =    |
e   |                                        |   e   |                                        |
B   |                                        |   B   |                             10~        |
G   |                                        |   G   |                   6    h9              |
D   |                   7    h9              |   D   |                   7                    |
A   |    7         9                         |   A   |7    h9                                 |
E   |9                                       |   E   |                                        |
```

Practice: call -> one bar of silence -> response; then remove the extra bar without losing the boundary.

Level 38 - Local Question-and-Answer Pairs (P3 / P4)

One position, two related sentences, and a deliberate phrase boundary.

P3 - THIRD-DEGREE FRAME - FRETS 9-12

Call ends F# (degree 6); answer ends A (root).

```
CALL                                                RESPONSE
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |E    F#   r    A    B    F#   r    r    |   Nte |C#   E    r    F#   E    C#   A    =    |
Deg |5    6    r    1    2    6    r    r    |   Deg |3    5    r    6    5    3    1    =    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    h    P    r    r    |   Atk |P    P    r    P    p    P    P    =    |
e   |                                        |   e   |                                        |
B   |              10   h12                  |   B   |                                        |
G   |9    h11                11              |   G   |     9         11   p9                  |
D   |                                        |   D   |11                       11             |
A   |                                        |   A   |                              12~       |
E   |                                        |   E   |                                        |
```

Practice: call -> one bar of silence -> response; then remove the extra bar without losing the boundary.

P4 - FIFTH-DEGREE FRAME - FRETS 11-14

Call ends F# (degree 6); answer ends A (root).

```
CALL                                                RESPONSE
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    C#   E    F#   r    r    |   Nte |E    F#   r    A    C#   B    A    =    |
Deg |1    2    r    3    5    6    r    r    |   Deg |5    6    r    1    3    2    1    =    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    h    P    r    r    |   Atk |P    h    r    P    P    P    p    =    |
e   |                                        |   e   |                                        |
B   |                                        |   B   |                                        |
G   |                     11                 |   G   |                                        |
D   |              11   h14                  |   D   |                   11                   |
A   |12   h14                                |   A   |              12        14   p12        |
E   |                                        |   E   |12   h14                                |
```

Practice: call -> one bar of silence -> response; then remove the extra bar without losing the boundary.

Level 38 - Local Question-and-Answer Pairs (P5)

One position, two related sentences, and a deliberate phrase boundary.

P5 - SIXTH-DEGREE FRAME - FRETS 14-17

Call ends F# (degree 6); answer ends A (root).

```
CALL                                                RESPONSE
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    C#   E    F#   r    r    |   Nte |E    C#   r    B    A    F#   A    =    |
Deg |1    2    r    3    5    6    r    r    |   Deg |5    3    r    2    1    6    1    =    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    h    P    r    r    |   Atk |P    p    r    P    p    P    P    =    |
e   |                        14             |   e   |                             17~       |
B   |               14   h17                 |   B   |17   p14                             |
G   |14   h16                                |   G   |               16   p14              |
D   |                                        |   D   |                         16          |
A   |                                        |   A   |                                     |
E   |                                        |   E   |                                     |
```

The answer crosses strings but stays inside Position 5. The final high A must arrive without a search.

Pass	Constraint	Success condition
1	Clap count only	Call and response occupy the intended eighth-note slots.
2	Play call only	Open ending sounds intentional; rests stay silent.
3	Play response only	Final A is centered and sustained.
4	Link each local pair	No extra pickup note appears between sentences.
5	Random position	Name P1-P5 and begin without running the box first.

Local-pair mastery check

Play all five pairs with D-start and U-start attack cycles; preserve the rests; make the response sound related; and resolve every answer without adding a last-second scale run.

Level 38 - I-IV-V Seam Phrase: P1 -> P2

Progression: | A call | D response | E call | A answer |

Targets: A root | F# over D | E over E | C# over A

Hear the lower frame ask the question. Let the D response establish P2, then return to A without hiding the seam.

BARS 1-2 - QUESTION AND FIRST HARMONIC ANSWER

The bar-2 target must sound before the ear notices the position change.

```
A call - P1                                   D response - P2
Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &   |   Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &   |
Nte |A   B   C#  E   r   C#  B   r   |   Nte |F#  A   B   A   r   F#  A   =   |
Deg |1   2   3   5   r   3   2   r   |   Deg |6   1   2   1   r   6   1   =   |
Atk |P   h   P   h   r   P   p   r   |   Atk |P   P   h   p   r   P   s   =   |
e   |                               |   e   |                                 |
B   |                               |   B   |                         7   /10 |
G   |                       6   p4  |   G   |                                 |
D   |                               |   D   |     7   h9  p7                  |
A   |         4   h7                |   A   |9                                |
E   |5   h7                         |   E   |                                 |
```

BARS 3-4 - SECOND QUESTION AND TONIC ANSWER

Do not lengthen the E call merely because the final A answer is approaching.

```
E call - P2                                   A answer - P1
Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &   |   Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &   |
Nte |E   F#  A   B   r   C#  B   r   |   Nte |C#  E   F#  E   C#  B   A   =   |
Deg |5   6   1   2   r   3   2   r   |   Deg |3   5   6   5   3   2   1   =   |
Atk |P   P   P   h   r   P   P   r   |   Atk |P   P   h   p   P   p   P   =   |
e   |                               |   e   |                                 |
B   |                               |   B   |     5   h7  p5                  |
G   |9                      6       |   G   |6                    6   p4      |
D   |         7   h9                |   D   |                         7~      |
A   |     9                         |   A   |                                 |
E   |                           7   |   E   |                                 |
```

Audit	Listen for
Target	The first sounding note belongs to the active chord.
Motif	The response shares rhythm, contour, or articulation with the call.
Seam	The hand moves without a tempo dip, scrape, or emergency filler.
Space	At least one printed rest remains truly silent.

Level 38 - I-IV-V Seam Phrase: P2 -> P3

Progression: | A call | D response | E call | A answer |

Targets: C# over A | A over D | E over E | C# over A

Use the shared fret-9 area as a landmark, not as a reason to stop the pulse. The response must sound like a new sentence.

BARS 1-2 - QUESTION AND FIRST HARMONIC ANSWER

The bar-2 target must sound before the ear notices the position change.

```
A call - P2                                   D response - P3
Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &   |   Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &   |
Nte |C#  B   A   B   r   C#  E   r   |   Nte |A   F#  B   C#  r   F#  A   =   |
Deg |3   2   1   2   r   3   5   r   |   Deg |1   6   2   3   r   6   1   =   |
Atk |P   p   P   h   r   P   h   r   |   Atk |P   p   P   h   r   P   P   =   |
e   |                               |   e   |                                 |
B   |                               |   B   |                         10~     |
G   |                   6   h9      |   G   |                     11          |
D   |         7   h9                |   D   |             9   h11             |
A   |                               |   A   |12  p9                           |
E   |9  p7                          |   E   |                                 |
```

BARS 3-4 - SECOND QUESTION AND TONIC ANSWER

Do not lengthen the E call merely because the final A answer is approaching.

```
E call - P3                                   A answer - P2
Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &   |   Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &   |
Nte |E   B   C#  B   r   A   B   r   |   Nte |C#  E   F#  A   r   E   A   =   |
Deg |5   2   3   2   r   1   2   r   |   Deg |3   5   6   1   r   5   1   =   |
Atk |P   P   h   p   r   P   h   r   |   Atk |P   s   P   h   r   P   P   =   |
e   |                               |   e   |                                 |
B   |                   10  h12     |   B   |             7   h10             |
G   |9                              |   G   |6   /9                           |
D   |     9   h11 p9                |   D   |                         7~      |
A   |                               |   A   |                     7           |
E   |                               |   E   |                                 |
```

Audit	Listen for
Target	The first sounding note belongs to the active chord.
Motif	The response shares rhythm, contour, or articulation with the call.
Seam	The hand moves without a tempo dip, scrape, or emergency filler.
Space	At least one printed rest remains truly silent.

Level 38 - I-IV-V Seam Phrase: P3 -> P4

Progression: | A call | D response | E call | A answer |

Targets: E over A | F# over D | E over E | C# over A

The middle-register response should preserve the call rhythm while changing contour and chord target.

BARS 1-2 - QUESTION AND FIRST HARMONIC ANSWER

The bar-2 target must sound before the ear notices the position change.

```
A call - P3                                   D response - P4
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |E    C#   A    B    r    C#   E    r    |   Nte |F#   A    B    A    r    F#   A    =    |
Deg |5    3    1    2    r    3    5    r    |   Deg |6    1    2    1    r    6    1    =    |
Atk |P    p    P    P    r    P    P    r    |   Atk |P    s    P    P    r    P    P    =    |
e   |                                         |   e   |                                        |
B   |               12                        |   B   |          12                            |
G   |                         9               |   G   |11   /14                     14~        |
D   |                    11                   |   D   |                                        |
A   |          12                             |   A   |               12                       |
E   |12   p9                                  |   E   |                         14             |
```

BARS 3-4 - SECOND QUESTION AND TONIC ANSWER

Do not lengthen the E call merely because the final A answer is approaching.

```
E call - P4                                   A answer - P3
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |E    B    C#   B    r    F#   E    r    |   Nte |C#   E    F#   E    r    B    A    =    |
Deg |5    2    3    2    r    6    5    r    |   Deg |3    5    6    5    r    2    1    =    |
Atk |P    P    P    P    r    P    P    r    |   Atk |P    h    P    p    r    P    p    =    |
e   |                                         |   e   |                                        |
B   |               12                        |   B   |                                        |
G   |                    11                   |   G   |                                        |
D   |14        11                             |   D   |11   h14                                |
A   |     14                                  |   A   |                         14   p12       |
E   |                         12              |   E   |          14   p12                      |
```

Audit	Listen for
Target	The first sounding note belongs to the active chord.
Motif	The response shares rhythm, contour, or articulation with the call.
Seam	The hand moves without a tempo dip, scrape, or emergency filler.
Space	At least one printed rest remains truly silent.

Level 38 - I-IV-V Seam Phrase: P4 -> P5

Progression: | A call | D response | E call | A answer |

Targets: A over A | F# over D | E/G# over E | C# over A

G#* appears only inside the E-major bar. Use it as the V third, then return to the five-note pool for the A answer.

BARS 1-2 - QUESTION AND FIRST HARMONIC ANSWER

The bar-2 target must sound before the ear notices the position change.

```
A call - P4/P5                                  D response - P5
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    C#   E    r    F#   E    r    |  Nte |F#   A    B    A    r    F#   A    =    |
Deg |1    2    3    5    r    6    5    r    |  Deg |6    1    2    1    r    6    1    =    |
Atk |P    h    P    h    r    P    p    r    |  Atk |P    P    h    p    r    P    s    =    |
e   |                        14   p12       |  e   |                             14   /17  |
B   |          14   h17                      |  B   |                                       |
G   |14   h16                                |  G   |     14   h16  p14                     |
D   |                                        |  D   |16                                     |
A   |                                        |  A   |                                       |
E   |                                        |  E   |                                       |
```

BARS 3-4 - SECOND QUESTION AND TONIC ANSWER

Do not lengthen the E call merely because the final A answer is approaching.

```
E call - P5                                     A answer - P5
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |E    B    C#   B    r    A    G#*  r    |  Nte |C#   E    F#   E    r    B    A    =    |
Deg |5    2    3    2    r    1    *3   r    |  Deg |3    5    6    5    r    2    1    =    |
Atk |P    P    P    p    r    P    p    r    |  Atk |P    P    h    p    r    P    P    =    |
e   |                                        |  e   |                                       |
B   |17                                      |  B   |                                       |
G   |     16                  14   p13       |  G   |                                       |
D   |                                        |  D   |     14   h16  p14                     |
A   |          16   p14                      |  A   |16                        14           |
E   |                                        |  E   |                               17~     |
```

Audit	Listen for
Target	The first sounding note belongs to the active chord.
Motif	The response shares rhythm, contour, or articulation with the call.
Seam	The hand moves without a tempo dip, scrape, or emergency filler.
Space	At least one printed rest remains truly silent.

Level 38 - Motif Transformation Lab

One seed becomes six useful responses without losing its identity.

Play the seed first. For each response, name the single changed parameter before playing it.

Seed question - P2 over A

Original rhythm and contour.

```
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    C#   B    r    r    r    |
Deg |1    2    r    3    2    r    r    r    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    P    r    r    r    |
G   |                 6                      |
D   |7    h9              9                  |
```

1. Exact echo

No change; use as an ear-memory check.

```
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    C#   B    r    r    r    |
Deg |1    2    r    3    2    r    r    r    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    P    r    r    r    |
G   |                 6                      |
D   |7    h9              9                  |
```

2. Harmonic answer over D

New chord target; same phrase family.

```
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |F#   A    r    B    A    r    r    r    |
Deg |6    1    r    2    1    r    r    r    |
Atk |P    P    r    P    P    r    r    r    |
D   |     7         9    7~                  |
A   |9                                       |
```

3. Contour contrast over E

Opposite directional answer over E.

```
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |E    B    r    A    B    r    r    r    |
Deg |5    2    r    1    2    r    r    r    |
Atk |P    P    r    P    P    r    r    r    |
D   |     9         7    9~                  |
A   |7                                       |
```

4. Position sequence - P3

Same contour in the next register.

```
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    C#   B    r    r    r    |
Deg |1    2    r    3    2    r    r    r    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    P    r    r    r    |
B   |10   h12             12                 |
D   |                11                      |
```

5. Rhythmic displacement

Same pitches begin one eighth note later.

```
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |r    A    B    r    C#   B    r    r    |
Deg |r    1    2    r    3    2    r    r    |
Atk |r    P    h    r    P    P    r    r    |
G   |                      6                 |
D   |     7    h9              9             |
```

6. Expansion and closure

Two extra tones create closure on A.

```
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    C#   E    C#   A    =    |
Deg |1    2    r    3    5    3    1    =    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    s    p    P    =    |
G   |                6    /9   p6             |
D   |7    h9                   7~             |
```

Random-response drill

Play the seed, wait one bar, choose a response card at random, and answer without rehearsing the box. Keep the same BPM for all six options.

Level 38 - Space and Density Ladder: Sparse

Three sounding tones per bar. Every rest must feel measured, not empty.

Progression: | A | D | E | A |. The targets are C# over A, F# over D, E over E, and A over A.

SPARSE BARS 1-2 - THREE TONES PER BAR

Count every silent eighth note. The D bar finishes on F#; the response is complete without a scale run.

```
A BAR                                                   D BAR
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |C#   r    r    E    r    r    A    r    |   Nte |F#   r    r    A    r    r    F#   r    |
Deg |3    r    r    5    r    r    1    r    |   Deg |6    r    r    1    r    r    6    r    |
Atk |P    r    r    P    r    r    P    r    |   Atk |P    r    r    P    r    r    P    r    |
e   |                                        |   e   |                                        |
B   |                        10~             |   B   |                                        |
G   |               9                        |   G   |11             14                       |
D   |11                                      |   D   |                                        |
A   |                                        |   A   |                                        |
E   |                                        |   E   |                             14~        |
```

SPARSE BARS 3-4 - THREE TONES PER BAR

The E bar states root and fifth; the final A bar resolves through C# to A.

```
E BAR                                                   A BAR
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |E    r    r    B    r    r    E    r    |   Nte |A    r    r    C#   r    r    A    r    |
Deg |5    r    r    2    r    r    5    r    |   Deg |1    r    r    3    r    r    1    r    |
Atk |P    r    r    P    r    r    P    r    |   Atk |P    r    r    P    r    r    P    r    |
e   |                                        |   e   |                                        |
B   |                                        |   B   |                                        |
G   |                                        |   G   |                             14~        |
D   |14                                      |   D   |               11                       |
A   |               14                       |   A   |12                                      |
E   |                        12~             |   E   |                                        |
```

Sparse-phrase test

Play the four bars twice: first with the printed rests, then with the guitar completely muted during every rest. The pulse and chord changes must remain identical.

Level 38 - Space and Density Ladder: Medium

Five sounding tones per bar. Add motion without covering the chord target.

Keep the same beat-1 targets and final A used in the sparse version. Only the internal motion becomes busier.

MEDIUM BARS 1-2 - FIVE TONES PER BAR

F# over A is motion; C# over D is major-7 color. Neither replaces the printed arrival target.

```
A BAR                                                 D BAR
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |C#   E    r    F#   r    E    A    r    |   Nte |F#   A    r    B    r    A    F#   r    |
Deg |3    5    r    6    r    5    1    r    |   Deg |6    1    r    2    r    1    6    r    |
Atk |P    P    r    P    r    P    P    r    |   Atk |P    P    r    P    r    P    P    r    |
e   |                                        |   e   |                                        |
B   |                                        |   B   |               12                       |
G   |                                        |   G   |11   14                                 |
D   |11   14                                 |   D   |                                        |
A   |                         12~            |   A   |                         12             |
E   |              14         12             |   E   |                              14~       |
```

MEDIUM BARS 3-4 - FIVE TONES PER BAR

The E bar moves through C# and B before resolving to E. The final tonic bar leaves the last eighth note empty.

```
E BAR                                                 A BAR
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |   Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |E    B    r    C#   r    B    E    r    |   Nte |A    B    r    C#   r    E    A    r    |
Deg |5    2    r    3    r    2    5    r    |   Deg |1    2    r    3    r    5    1    r    |
Atk |P    P    r    P    r    P    P    r    |   Atk |P    P    r    P    r    P    P    r    |
e   |                                        |   e   |                                        |
B   |                         12             |   B   |                                        |
G   |                                        |   G   |                              14~       |
D   |14             11                       |   D   |               11        14             |
A   |     14                                 |   A   |12   14                                 |
E   |                         12~            |   E   |                                        |
```

Medium-phrase test

Record sparse and medium back to back at one BPM. The second version may contain more notes, but the chord targets, phrase length, and amount of bar-end space must stay clear.

Level 38 - Space and Density Ladder: Dense Control

Seven sounding tones per bar. Density is allowed; autopilot is not.

DENSE BARS 1-2 - SEVEN TONES PER BAR

C# over D is motion, not the resting point. Preserve the beat-1 F# target and the final A.

```
A BAR                                   D BAR
Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &  |  Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &  |
Nte |C#  E   F#  E   C#  B   A   r  |  Nte |F#  A   B   C#  A   F#  A   r  |
Deg |3   5   6   5   3   2   1   r  |  Deg |6   1   2   3   1   6   1   r  |
Atk |P   P   P   P   P   P   P   r  |  Atk |P   P   P   P   P   P   P   r  |
e   |                                |  e   |                             |
B   |                                |  B   |         12  14              |
G   |                                |  G   |11  14                   14~ |
D   |11  14          11              |  D   |                             |
A   |                    14  12~     |  A   |                 12          |
E   |        14  12                  |  E   |                     14      |
```

DENSE BARS 3-4 - SEVEN TONES PER BAR

A over E is suspended tension; the line resolves through F# to E before the tonic answer.

```
E BAR                                   A BAR
Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &  |  Cnt |1   &   2   &   3   &   4   &  |
Nte |E   B   C#  B   A   F#  E   r  |  Nte |A   B   C#  E   F#  E   A   r  |
Deg |5   2   3   2   1   6   5   r  |  Deg |1   2   3   5   6   5   1   r  |
Atk |P   P   P   P   P   P   P   r  |  Atk |P   P   P   P   P   P   P   r  |
e   |                                |  e   |                             |
B   |            12                  |  B   |                             |
G   |                11              |  G   |                         14~ |
D   |14      11                      |  D   |         11  14              |
A   |    14          12              |  A   |12  14                       |
E   |                    12~         |  E   |                 14  12      |
```

Echo

Same rhythm; change the target.

Contrast

Reverse contour; keep the target time.

Move

Answer from the neighboring position.

Delay

Begin the answer on the and of 1.

Shorten

Remove two notes and leave beat 4 empty.

Ornament

Add one legato, slide, bend, or vibrato event.

Density test

Play sparse, medium, and dense at one BPM. More notes may never erase the target or the phrase boundary.

Level 38 - Model 12-Bar Call-and-Response Chorus

BARS 1-4: A | A | A | A POSITIONS: P1 -> P2 -> P2 -> P3

The first sounding note of every bar is the harmonic target. Keep the phrase rhythm when replacing the remaining notes.

FIRST TWO BARS

Question ends on degree 6. Answer resolves to A.

```
1. A CALL - P1                                  2. A RESPONSE - P2
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    r    B    C#   F#   r    r    |  Nte |C#   B    r    A    C#   E    A    =    |
Deg |1    2    r    2    3    6    r    r    |  Deg |3    2    r    1    3    5    1    =    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    b    P    r    r    |  Atk |P    p    r    P    P    s    P    =    |
e   |                                        |  e   |                                        |
B   |                                        |  B   |                              10~       |
G   |               4    b6                  |  G   |                         6    /9        |
D   |                         4              |  D   |                    7                   |
A   |                                        |  A   |                                        |
E   |5    h7                                 |  E   |9    p7                                 |
```

SECOND TWO BARS

Second call reuses the rhythm. Response reaches the middle register.

```
3. A CALL - P2                                  4. A RESPONSE - P3
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |E    F#   r    A    B    F#   r    r    |  Nte |C#   E    r    F#   A    B    A    =    |
Deg |5    6    r    1    2    6    r    r    |  Deg |3    5    r    6    1    2    1    =    |
Atk |P    h    r    P    h    P    r    r    |  Atk |P    P    r    P    P    h    P    =    |
e   |                                        |  e   |                                        |
B   |                         7              |  B   |                         10   h12       |
G   |                                        |  G   |     9              11                  |
D   |               7    h9                  |  D   |11                                      |
A   |7    h9                                 |  A   |                              12~       |
E   |                                        |  E   |                                        |
```

Call-to-response conversion

Pass 1: play exactly as written. Pass 2: keep the call bars and replace only the response bars. Pass 3: keep only the rhythm and beat-1 targets. Do not increase density yet.

Level 38 - Model 12-Bar Call-and-Response Chorus

BARS 5-8: D | D | A | A POSITIONS: P3 -> P4 -> P4 -> P5

The first sounding note of every bar is the harmonic target. Keep the phrase rhythm when replacing the remaining notes.

FIRST TWO BARS

D* completes the IV chord. D response settles on A.

```
5. D CALL - P3                                  6. D RESPONSE - P4
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |D*   F#   A    B    r    C#   A    r    |  Nte |F#   A    B    A    r    F#   A    =    |
Deg |*R   6    1    2    r    3    1    r    |  Deg |6    1    2    1    r    6    1    =    |
Atk |P    P    P    P    r    P    P    r    |  Atk |P    P    s    p    r    P    P    =    |
e   |10                                       |  e   |                                       |
B   |          10   12                        |  B   |                                       |
G   |     11                                  |  G   |                          11   14~     |
D   |                          11             |  D   |                                       |
A   |                               12        |  A   |     12   /14  p12                     |
E   |                                         |  E   |14                                     |
```

SECOND TWO BARS

A call climbs toward Position 5. Answer returns to the tonic.

```
7. A CALL - P4                                  8. A RESPONSE - P5
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    C#   E    r    F#   B    r    |  Nte |C#   E    F#   E    r    B    A    =    |
Deg |1    2    3    5    r    6    2    r    |  Deg |3    5    6    5    r    2    1    =    |
Atk |P    P    P    P    r    h    P    r    |  Atk |P    P    h    p    r    P    P    =    |
e   |              12        h14              |  e   |                                       |
B   |          14                  12         |  B   |                                       |
G   |14                                       |  G   |                                       |
D   |                                         |  D   |     14   h16  p14                     |
A   |     14                                  |  A   |16                          14         |
E   |                                         |  E   |                               17~     |
```

Mid-chorus position development

D* is the IV root, not a new scale degree. Let the D response establish Position 4; the following A call climbs toward Position 5 without an audible reset.

Level 38 - Model 12-Bar Call-and-Response Chorus

BARS 9-12: E | D | A | E POSITIONS: P5 -> P4 -> P3 -> P1

The first sounding note of every bar is the harmonic target. Keep the phrase rhythm when replacing the remaining notes.

FIRST TWO BARS

G#* states the V third. D response resolves C# tension.

```
9. E CALL - P5                                  10. D RESPONSE - P4
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |G#*  B    E    F#   r    A    B    r    |  Nte |F#   A    B    C#   r    A    F#   =    |
Deg |*3   2    5    6    r    1    2    r    |  Deg |6    1    2    3    r    1    6    =    |
Atk |P    P    P    P    r    P    h    r    |  Atk |P    s    P    h    r    P    P    =    |
e   |16             14                       |  e   |                                        |
B   |          17                            |  B   |          12   h14                      |
G   |     16                  14   h16       |  G   |11   /14                                |
D   |                                        |  D   |                                        |
A   |                                        |  A   |                          12            |
E   |                                        |  E   |                               14~      |
```

SECOND TWO BARS

Final A answer leaves space. E turnaround ends on B and invites the next chorus.

```
11. A ANSWER - P3                               12. E TURNAROUND - P1
Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |  Cnt |1    &    2    &    3    &    4    &    |
Nte |A    B    C#   E    r    C#   A    =    |  Nte |E    F#   A    B    r    G#*  B    r    |
Deg |1    2    3    5    r    3    1    =    |  Deg |5    6    1    2    r    *3   2    r    |
Atk |P    P    P    P    r    P    P    =    |  Atk |P    P    P    P    r    P    P    r    |
e   |                        9               |  e   |                                        |
B   |     12                       10~       |  B   |                                        |
G   |               9                        |  G   |                   4                    |
D   |          11                            |  D   |     4    7                             |
A   |12                                      |  A   |7                                       |
E   |                                        |  E   |                          4    7         |
```

Turnaround and repeat

G#* belongs only to the E bars. Bar 11 is the final tonic answer; bar 12 becomes a short V turnaround and ends on B so the next A chorus can begin cleanly.

Level 38 - Three-Chorus Improvisation Capstone

Freedom increases only after the harmonic and phrasing constraints remain audible.

Chorus	Pitch / position limits	Phrase constraint	Required evidence
1 - Skeleton and space	P1-P2 only; pentatonic only	Max 3 tones per bar; one full beat of silence per two bars	Every chord change is audible without accompaniment.
2 - Motif development	At least four positions; two seams	One seed motif; one transformation per two-bar pair	Listener can identify the recurring idea.
3 - Free synthesis	All positions and horizontal lanes; D*/G#* optional	Max 7 tones per bar; at least two deliberately sparse bars	Ends on A by design; articulation stays in tune.

Response cards - choose one per two-bar pair

1 Echo

Same rhythm; new target.

2 Reverse

Opposite contour; same target time.

3 Re-position

Answer in the next frame.

4 Delay

Enter one eighth note later.

5 Reduce

Remove two notes; leave beat 4 empty.

6 Expand

Add one controlled articulation.

Score 0-2	0	1	2
Harmony	Changes disappear	Some targets land	All changes audible
Motif	No recurring idea	Idea appears inconsistently	Call and response clearly related
Space	Continuous filling	Some counted rests	Silence shapes every pair
Neck movement	Fret search or reset	Mostly secure seams	Movement is rhythmically invisible
Articulation	Pitch/muting unstable	Mixed accuracy	Pitch, timing, and muting controlled
Recovery	Stops after error	Recovers late	Recovers inside the phrase

Recording rule

Keep the first complete take. Score it before recording again. Advance after 10/12 or better on two separate days.

Level 38 - Practice Progression, Mastery Gate, and Log

The section is complete only when the harmony and phrase shape survive after the written notes are removed.

Eight-phase practice progression

1	Clap and speak each local pair.
2	Play all five local pairs with both attack starts.
3	Complete four seam phrases; audit beat-1 targets.
4	Transform the seed in all six printed ways.
5	Play sparse, medium, and dense at one BPM.
6	Learn the model chorus in four-bar blocks.
7	Replace response bars while preserving calls.
8	Record and score the three-chorus capstone.

Error diagnosis

NO RESPONSE CONTRAST	Change one parameter only.
LATE TARGET	Sing it before the barline.
NO SPACE	Remove beat 4 from every call.
MOTIF DISAPPEARS	Freeze the rhythm; change the ending.
SHIFT BREAK	Loop final call note -> seam -> target.
PULSE HIDDEN	Remove articulation and restore count.
WRONG D* / G#*	Return to pentatonic-only targets.
TENSION	Shorten to four bars; reduce 4-6 BPM.

Mastery gate - Section IV complete

Play all five local pairs and four seam phrases; transform one motif six ways; preserve targets through sparse, medium, and dense versions; perform the model chorus from memory; record the three-chorus capstone on two separate days; make every chord change audible without a backing track; use at least one full beat of silence per two-bar pair; use D* and G#* only on IV and V; and end on A by choice.

Date	Focus	Tempo	Score /12	Weak phrase / seam	Next target

NEXT - SECTION V: RELATIVE MINOR PENTATONIC AND BLUES

Re-center the fretboard around minor pentatonic, then add the blues note, minor-key bends, dominant-blues phrasing, and applications.